Owen Abel Amenze

cv@owenabel.com | London, UK | LinkedIn | GitHub | owenabel.com

SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer building product and backend systems end to end. Led data and search for Open Policy Finder, moved Jisc's main site to serverless infrastructure, and built Go APIs and durable jobs for Receipts.

EXPERIENCE

Product Engineer – *Out of Office Collective* London, **Mar 2025 - Jun 2026**

Fête Finder

- Built Fête Finder's ticket exchange and bot, sharing site listings with a 2,000-member WhatsApp chat.
- Built autonomous agents to scan event and ticketing pages for listing suggestions; AI flyer extraction supplied field evidence and confidence for human review.
- Designed MapLibre geospatial discovery with geocoding and fallbacks for incomplete location data.
- Built first-party discovery and event-engagement analytics feeding partner reports with unique-session measures; the June 2026 recap recorded 54,295 page views and 10,270 outbound clicks.

Senior Software Developer – *Jisc* Bristol, **Apr 2024 - Feb 2026**

Open Policy Finder · Sherpa Team

- Led a three-developer data team and delivered Open Policy Finder's Next.js MVP after agreeing November launch scope with product owners.
- Retired Elasticsearch when PostgreSQL met search needs at our scale, removing a costly index-sync layer during dataset migration.
- Created the help-page CMS with Directus and a Markdown publishing workflow.
- Built a journal and agreement ingestion loop with normalisation, error tracing and alerts; fed monthly quality reports back to data stewards for correction.
- Prototyped local MCP tools for code inspection, data queries, project checks and authenticated app interaction.

Jisc Website · Digital Experience Team

- Led a time-critical move of Jisc's main site from failure-prone EC2 containers to AWS ECS Fargate and RDS, owning hosting options and cost appraisal.
- Maintained its Wagtail/Next.js CMS; helped replace an underused staging environment with Terraform-managed ephemeral previews and added Playwright release checks.

Software Engineer – *TempTribe* London, **Jun 2018 - Jun 2020**

- Refactored REST APIs and implemented a scheduling algorithm to reduce shift conflicts.

Software Developer – *Hypixel Inc and Dungeon Realms* United States, **May 2016 - Jun 2017**

- Delivered multiplayer game features and payment-flow improvements with QA and design teams.

SELECTED WORK

Receipts.beauty – Find beauty professionals through real work & reviews (private beta) *Lead Engineer*

owenabel.com/work/receipts-discovery

- Built Go APIs and PostgreSQL workers with generated Protobuf/ConnectRPC contracts for the web app and mobile API client; committed jobs with product changes and used leases and retries for crash recovery.
- Used Zitadel for sign-in; managed revocable sessions and permissions for each provider workspace in Go, with CLI and MCP access limited to approved actions.
- Built a NATS-backed WebSocket gateway for live updates and PostgreSQL replay after reconnects; instrumented APIs and workers with OpenTelemetry traces, metrics and Grafana alerts.
- Built search by words, photos and location; pgvector identifies similar work, while ranking explanations separate visual matches from provider claims and reviews.
- Built a custom Go vet tool that flags misplaced API, authorization, database and background-job code in CI, so human and AI contributors know what to fix before merge.

Milk & Henny – Events, stories & games that bring people together *Founder & Host*

owenabel.com/work/milk-and-henny-operations · Play Hot & Cold

- Built Stripe Checkout with signature-checked webhooks for idempotent ticket issuance and PostgreSQL QR admission that prevents duplicate online claims.
- Built passwordless attendee access with one-time email links/codes and passkeys, backed by rotating, revocable sessions and step-up checks for sensitive actions.
- Built Hot & Cold for daily and shared-room play, plus live event games with server-side scoring, shared state and host controls.
- Built a Cloudflare R2 object storage pipeline: private presigned uploads, processed responsive variants, published galleries, signed original downloads and expiring transfers.

EDUCATION

Bachelor (Hons) Computer Science - First Class **Oct 2020 - Jun 2023**

University of Essex Colchester

SKILLS

Languages	TypeScript, Go, JavaScript, Python, Java, Bash
Application engineering	Node.js, React, Next.js, TanStack Start, Django/Wagtail, ConnectRPC
Data & messaging	PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, Redis, NATS JetStream
Infrastructure	AWS, Cloudflare, Docker, Terraform, CI/CD
Observability & testing	OpenTelemetry, Grafana, Vitest, Playwright